

Using MathCompile

MathCompile is a worksheet of math cells. Type math on the left, and the output column on the right gives you the result in the format you pick: LaTeX source, computed answers, or SymPy Python code. It runs entirely in your browser and saves your worksheet automatically.

The worksheet at a glance

- **Cells** are numbered rows. Click a cell to edit it; the up and down arrow keys move between cells when the caret reaches an edge. **+ Add expression** appends a cell, and **×** deletes one. Pressing Backspace in a cell that holds only blank space deletes it too.
- **The output column** shows whatever the current output target produces for each cell. Drag the divider between the columns to resize it.
- **The header** holds Smart mode, the Output target picker, the dark-mode toggle, and the Commands button (or press `Ctrl+K` / `⌘K`).
- **How do I...**, under the cell list, is a quick keystroke cheat sheet. This document is the long version.

The command palette (`Ctrl+K`) covers: insert an expression below, duplicate the current one, delete it, clear all expressions, toggle Smart mode and dark mode, switch the output target, and jump to any cell by number.

Typing math

Smart mode (the default)

With Smart mode on — the checkbox in the header — you rarely need a backslash. Whole words convert to symbols as you type, and a digit right after a letter becomes a subscript:

Type	Get
int	$\int$ with upper and lower bound blocks
iint or antid	a bare $\int$ for indefinite integrals
sum , prod	Σ , Π with bound blocks
sqrt	$\sqrt{}$
pi , theta , infty	π , θ , ∞
derivative	$\frac{d}{d}$ — caret lands in the denominator
def	the function-definition marker (see <i>Output</i>)
x2	x_2

Operator names like `sin` , `lim` , and `det` stay upright and space correctly without any command.

LaTeX commands

Type `\` followed by a command name — `\frac`, `\sqrt`, `\int`, `\alpha` — and press **Enter** or **Space** to accept it. As you type, a suggestion menu lists matching commands; the arrow keys highlight and Enter accepts the highlight, or just keep typing to filter. `Esc` dismisses the menu. Word-runs of two or more letters suggest too (`sq` offers `\sqrt`).

`Ctrl+Space` opens the searchable symbol picker: type to filter, Enter inserts, `Esc` closes.

Unicode characters insert directly — typing `α`, `≤`, `∫`, `∀` just works.

Common things you'll type

You want	Type
Fraction	<code>1/2</code> , or <code>\frac</code> then fill the blocks
Subscript / superscript	<code>_</code> , <code>^</code> (or <code>x2</code> in Smart mode)
Square / nth root	<code>sqrt</code> , or <code>\nthroot</code>
Sum / product with bounds	<code>sum</code> or <code>prod</code> , then <code>_</code> and <code>^</code>
Definite integral	<code>int</code> , then <code>_</code> and <code>^</code>
Indefinite integral	<code>iint</code> or <code>antid</code> — add bounds later with <code>_</code>
Limit	<code>\lim</code> , then <code>_</code> for $x \rightarrow 0$
Binomial coefficient	<code>\binom</code>
Matrix	<code>\pmatrix</code> — Enter adds a row, <code>Shift+Space</code> a column
Piecewise	<code>\cases</code>
Greek letters	<code>\alpha</code> , <code>\beta</code> , ... or <code>\pi</code> , <code>\theta</code> , <code>\infty</code>
Text inside math	<code>\text{...}</code>
Accents	<code>\dot</code> , <code>\ddot</code> , <code>\bar</code> , <code>\hat</code> , <code>\vec</code> , <code>\tilde</code>
Sets	<code>\in</code> , <code>\notin</code> , <code>\subseteq</code> , <code>\cup</code> , <code>\cap</code> , <code>\emptyset</code> , <code>\mathbb{R}</code>
Relations	<code>\leq</code> , <code>\geq</code> , <code>\neq</code> , <code>\approx</code> , <code>\pm</code>
Arrows	<code>\to</code> , <code>\rightarrow</code> , <code>\Leftrightarrow</code>
Calculus	<code>\partial</code> , <code>\nabla</code> , <code>\infty</code> , <code>\prime</code>
Logic	<code>\forall</code> , <code>\exists</code> , <code>\therefore</code> , <code>\land</code> , <code>\lor</code> , <code>\not</code>

`SYMBOLS.md` in the repository lists every command the editor accepts.

Getting in and out of blocks

Commands like `\frac` open placeholder blocks, and the caret stays inside the block you're filling. Everything you type lands there — including `+` , `=` , and spaces. To move on:

- **Right** or **Tab** steps out of the current block.
- `(` `[` `{` insert closed pairs with the caret inside; typing the closer again hops over it. `\angle` pairs with `\rangle` .

- Backspace clears the block you're in before it removes the command that owns it.

Multi-line cells and cells

Enter starts a new line inside the same cell (useful for aligned derivations); **Shift+Enter** starts a whole new cell. While a `\command` input is still open, Enter accepts the command instead of breaking a line.

Matrices and environments

Environments open two ways: type `\name` directly (the shortcut) or `\begin{name}` the long way.

Environment	What it's for
<code>matrix</code> , <code>pmatrix</code> , <code>bmatrix</code> , <code>Bmatrix</code> , <code>vmatrix</code> , <code>Vmatrix</code>	grids in <code>()</code> , <code>[]</code> , <code>{}</code> , <code> </code> , <code> </code> , <code> </code> brackets
<code>smallmatrix</code>	inline mini matrix
<code>cases</code>	piecewise definitions
<code>gathered</code> , <code>gather</code> , <code>equation</code> , <code>multline</code> , <code>flalign</code>	centered line groups
<code>aligned</code> , <code>align</code> , <code>split</code>	alignment at <code>&</code>
<code>array</code> , <code>tabular</code>	grids with a column spec — <code>\array{cc}</code>
<code>subarray</code>	compact subscript stack — <code>\subarray{c}</code>
<code>alignat</code> , <code>alignedat</code>	aligned with a pair count — <code>\alignat{2}</code>
<code>substack</code>	multi-line subscripts

The `array` / `tabular` / `subarray` / `alignat` / `alignedat` environments take a required argument; typing `\array` opens a pending `{ }` block for it — type the spec (`cc`, `l|r`) and press `}`, `Enter`, or `Tab` to apply it. `\begin{...}` also accepts `eqnarray` and `eqalign` (both open an aligned grid); those two have no `\name` shortcut. `\pmatrix{a&b\\c&d}` and friends also work as bare commands with one brace argument.

Inside a matrix or aligned grid: **Enter** adds a row, **Shift+Space** adds a column, and the arrow keys walk cell to cell. `&` separates columns and `\\` ends a row in the stored LaTeX.

Output targets

Pick a target from the **Output** menu in the header.

LaTeX

The output column shows each cell's serialized LaTeX; **Copy** puts it on the clipboard.

Calculator

Each cell evaluates through SymPy — a real computer-algebra system that runs in the page as WebAssembly. It takes a while to download and boot; until the engine is ready, results come from a lightweight JavaScript engine and are dimmed and marked *estimate*. The chip at the top shows engine status.

- Each statement in a cell gets a result row; `≈` adds a decimal approximation when one exists.
- `!` marks a statement that failed, `i` a note; hover for the message.
- **Show generating code** reveals the exact Python program that produced the results, with a copy button.
- The **Settings** menu (calculator and Python targets) exposes display plumbing and animation timing — default values are fine.

Python

The output column shows the SymPy program MathCompile generates per cell, syntax-highlighted. **Copy** grabs one cell's lines; **Copy script** grabs the whole worksheet as one runnable program. The `import *` checkbox controls the import style. Statements the compiler can't express appear as `! / i` notes under the code.

One rule to know: write `\text{def} f(x) = 2x` (type `def` in Smart mode) to define a function — the generated code is `def f(x): return 2*x`. A bare `f(x)` is read as multiplication, `f * x`.

Keyboard reference

Key	What it does
Enter	new line in the cell; accepts an open <code>\command</code> ; adds a row in a matrix
Shift+Enter	new cell below
Right , Tab	step out of the current block
Esc	dismiss the autocomplete menu or picker; returns focus to the field
Ctrl+Space	open the symbol picker
Ctrl+K / ⌘K	command palette
Shift+Space	new column inside a matrix
↑ , ↓	move between cells at field edges
Home , End	block edges (Ctrl+Home / Ctrl+End for the whole field)
Backspace on a blank cell	delete the cell

Saving

The worksheet, theme, Smart mode, and target choice persist in your browser's local storage — there's nothing to click. Clearing the site's data resets everything.

Repository docs: `README.md` (build/run), `SYMBOLS.md` (command inventory), `AGENTS.md` (architecture), `CALCULATOR-ENGINES.md` (calculator internals).